

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12413277
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Petersson; Sven et al.

Polarized reception of reference signals at a terminal device

Abstract

There is provided mechanisms for polarized reception of reference signals. A method is performed by a terminal device. The terminal device is equipped with an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements. The antenna array is connected to a baseband chain in the terminal device. The method comprises receiving, during a beam management procedure with a TRP, two reference signals transmitted in one OFDM symbol each from the same TRP port within a slot. The two reference signals are received using a filter with a first polarization for a first of the two reference signals and with a second polarization for a second of the two reference signals. The second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.

Inventors:	Petersson; Sven (Sävedalen, SE), Nilsson; Andreas (Gothenburg, SE)
Applicant:	Telefonaktiebolaget LM Ericsson (publ) (Stockholm, SE)
Family ID:	70154391
Assignee:	TELEFONAKTIEBOLAGET LM ERICSSON (PUBL) (Stockholm, SE)
Appl. No.:	18/623865
Filed:	April 01, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240243792 A1	Jul. 18, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17914001 US 11962378 WO PCT/EP2020/059008 20200330 child-doc US 18623865

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04B7/06 (20060101); H04B7/10 (20170101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04B7/0617 (20130101); H04B7/063 (20130101); H04B7/10 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04B (7/0617); H04B (7/10); H04B (7/063)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
11647530	12/2022	Landis	370/329	H04B 7/088
11962378	12/2023	Petersson	N/A	H04B 7/0617
2018/0183509	12/2017	Luo	N/A	N/A
2019/0386733	12/2018	Nilsson et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0387441	12/2018	Koskela et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0367230	12/2019	Raghavan	N/A	N/A
2020/0396035	12/2019	Yu	N/A	N/A
2022/0029676	12/2021	Ramireddy	N/A	N/A
2023/0105291	12/2022	Abedini	370/329	H04W 74/0841
2024/0243799	12/2023	Enescu	N/A	H04B 7/0695

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
110392438	12/2018	CN	N/A
110603795	12/2018	CN	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

International Search Report and Written Opinion issued in International Application No.

PCT/EP2020/059008 dated Oct. 30, 2020 (10 pages). cited by applicant

Sony, “Enhancements on multi-beam operation”, 3GPP TSG RAN WG1#98 meeting, R1-1908784, Prague, CZ, Aug. 2019 (9 pages). cited by applicant

Qualcomm, “Breaking the wireless barriers to mobilize 5G NR mmWave”, Jan. 2019 (39 pages). cited by applicant

English translation of Chinese Search Report accompanying a Chinese Office Action issued in Chinese Patent Application No. 202080099279.7 dated Jan. 13, 2025 (3 pages). cited by applicant

Xu, M., “Planning Method for WCDMA Base Station Antennas,” Oct. 23, 2011 (1 page). cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Ha; Dac V

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Rothwell, Figg, Ernst & Manbeck, P.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/914,001, filed on 2022 Sep. 23 (status pending), which is the 35 U.S.C. § 371 National Stage of International Patent Application No. PCT/EP2020/059008, filed 2020 Mar. 30. The above identified applications are incorporated by this reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments presented herein relate to a method, a terminal device, a computer program, and a computer program product for polarized reception of reference signals.

BACKGROUND

(2) In communications networks, there may be a challenge to obtain good performance and capacity for a given communications protocol, its parameters and the physical environment in which the communications network is deployed.

(3) For example, for future generations of mobile communications networks, frequency bands at many different carrier frequencies could be needed. For example, low such frequency bands could be needed to achieve sufficient network coverage for wireless devices and higher frequency bands (e.g. at millimeter wavelengths (mmW), i.e. near and above 30 GHz) could be needed to reach required network capacity. In general terms, at high frequencies the propagation properties of the radio channel are more challenging and beamforming both at the network node of the network and at the wireless devices might be required to reach a sufficient link budget.

(4) Narrow beam transmission and reception schemes might be needed at such high frequencies to compensate the expected high propagation loss. For a given communication link, a respective beam can be applied at both the network-end (as represented by a network node or its transmission and reception point, TRP) and at the terminal-end (as represented by a terminal device), which typically is referred to as a beam pair link (BPL). A BPL (i.e. both the beam used by the network node and the beam used by the terminal device) is expected to be discovered and monitored by the network using measurements on downlink reference signals, such as channel state information reference signals (CSI-RS) or synchronization signal block (SSB) signals, used for beam management.

(5) A beam management procedure can be used for discovery and maintenance of beam pair links. In some aspects, the beam management procedure is defined in terms of a P-1 sub-procedure, a P-2 sub-procedure, and a P-3 sub-procedure.

(6) The CSI-RS for beam management can be transmitted periodically, semi-persistently or aperiodically (event triggered) and they can be either shared between multiple terminal devices or be device-specific. The SSB are transmitted periodically and are shared for all terminal devices. In order for the terminal device to find a suitable network node beam, the network node, during the P-1 sub-procedure, transmits the reference signal in different transmission (TX) beams on which the terminal device performs measurements, such as reference signal received power (RSRP), and reports back the N best TX beams (where N can be configured by the network). Furthermore, the transmission of the reference signal on a given TX beam can be repeated to allow the terminal device to evaluate a suitable reception (RX) beam. Reference signals that are shared between all terminal devices served by the TRP might be used to determine a first coarse direction for the terminal devices. It could be suitable for such a periodic TX beam sweep at the TRP to use SSB as the reference signal. One reason for this is that SSB are anyway transmitted periodically (for initial access/synchronization purposes) and SSBs are also expected to be beamformed at higher frequencies to overcome the higher propagation losses noted above.

(7) A finer beam sweep in more narrow beams than used during the P-1 sub-procedure might then be performed at the network node during a P-2 sub-procedure to determine a more detailed direction for each terminal device. Here, the CSI-RS might be used as reference signal. As for the

- P-1 sub-procedure, the terminal device performs measurements, such as reference signal received power (RSRP), and reports back the N best TX beams (where N can be configured by the network).
- (8) Furthermore, the CSI-RS transmission in the transmission beam selected during the P-2 sub-procedure can be repeated in a P-3 sub-procedure to allow the terminal device to evaluate suitable RX beams at the terminal device.
- (9) However, in some aspects, which beam in the respective beam management sub-processes is reported and/or selected by a terminal device as the best beam (e.g., in terms of RSRP) to some extent depends on the antenna architecture at the terminal device. Such aspects are not considered during current beam management procedures.
- (10) Hence, there is still a need for improved beam management procedures.

SUMMARY

- (11) An object of embodiments herein is to provide beam management procedures that take into account the antenna architecture at the terminal device.
- (12) According to a first aspect there is presented a method for polarized reception of reference signals. The method is performed by a terminal device. The terminal device is equipped with an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements. The antenna array is connected to a baseband chain in the terminal device. The method comprises receiving, during a beam management procedure with a TRP, two reference signals transmitted in one orthogonal frequency-division multiplexing (OFDM) symbol each from the same TRP port within a slot. The two reference signals are received using a filter with a first polarization for a first of the two reference signals and with a second polarization for a second of the two reference signals. The second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.
- (13) According to a second aspect there is presented a terminal device for polarized reception of reference signals. The terminal device is equipped with an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements. The antenna array is connected to a baseband chain in the terminal device. The terminal device further comprises processing circuitry. The processing circuitry is configured to cause the terminal device to receive, during a beam management procedure with a TRP, two reference signals transmitted in one OFDM symbol each from the same TRP port within a slot. The two reference signals are received using a filter with a first polarization for a first of the two reference signals and with a second polarization for a second of the two reference signals. The second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.
- (14) According to a third aspect there is presented a terminal device for polarized reception of reference signals. The terminal device is equipped with an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements. The antenna array is connected to a baseband chain in the terminal device. The terminal device further comprises a receive module configured to receive, during a beam management procedure with a TRP, two reference signals transmitted in one OFDM symbol each from the same TRP port within a slot. The two reference signals are received using a filter with a first polarization for a first of the two reference signals and with a second polarization for a second of the two reference signals. The second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.
- (15) According to a fourth aspect there is presented a computer program for polarized reception of reference signals, the computer program comprising computer program code which, when run on a terminal device equipped with an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements, the antenna array being connected to a baseband chain in the terminal device, causes the terminal device to perform a method according to the first aspect.
- (16) According to a fifth aspect there is presented a computer program product comprising a computer program according to the fourth aspect and a computer readable storage medium on which the computer program is stored. The computer readable storage medium could be a non-transitory computer readable storage medium.
- (17) Advantageously, these aspects enable the beam management procedures to take into account the antenna architecture at the terminal device.

- (18) Advantageously, these aspects improve the beam management procedure.
- (19) Advantageously, these aspects improve the beam management procedure by enabling improvement in the beam selection at the terminal device.
- (20) Other objectives, features and advantages of the enclosed embodiments will be apparent from the following detailed disclosure, from the attached dependent claims as well as from the drawings.
- (21) Generally, all terms used in the claims are to be interpreted according to their ordinary meaning in the technical field, unless explicitly defined otherwise herein. All references to “a/an/the element, apparatus, component, means, module, step, etc.” are to be interpreted openly as referring to at least one instance of the element, apparatus, component, means, module, step, etc., unless explicitly stated otherwise. The steps of any method disclosed herein do not have to be performed in the exact order disclosed, unless explicitly stated.
-

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The inventive concept is now described, by way of example, with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a communication network according to embodiments;
- (3) FIG. 2 schematically illustrates the antenna architecture of a terminal device according to an embodiment;
- (4) FIG. 3 schematically illustrates a beam management procedure according to embodiments;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of methods according to embodiments;
- (6) FIG. 5 schematically illustrates spatial beam patterns in different polarizations as generated by a terminal device according to an embodiment;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram showing functional units of a terminal device according to an embodiment;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram showing functional modules of a terminal device according to an embodiment;
- (9) FIG. 8 shows one example of a computer program product comprising computer readable storage medium according to an embodiment;
- (10) FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram illustrating a telecommunication network connected via an intermediate network to a host computer in accordance with some embodiments; and
- (11) FIG. 10 is a schematic diagram illustrating host computer communicating via a radio base station with a terminal device over a partially wireless connection in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (12) The inventive concept will now be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which certain embodiments of the inventive concept are shown. This inventive concept may however, be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein; rather, these embodiments are provided by way of example so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the inventive concept to those skilled in the art. Like numbers refer to like elements throughout the description. Any step or feature illustrated by dashed lines should be regarded as optional.
- (13) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a communication network **100** where embodiments presented herein can be applied. The communication network **100** could be a third generation (3G) telecommunications network, a fourth generation (4G) telecommunications network, a fifth generation (5G) telecommunications network, or any evolution thereof, and support any 3GPP telecommunications standard, where applicable.
- (14) The communication network **100** comprises a network node **140** configured to provide

network access to terminal devices, as represented by terminal device **200**, in a radio access network **110**. The radio access network **110** is operatively connected to a core network **120**. The core network **120** is in turn operatively connected to a service network **130**, such as the Internet. The terminal device **200** is thereby enabled to, via the network node **200**, access services of, and exchange data with, the service network **130**.

(15) The network node **140** comprises, is collocated with, is integrated with, or is in operational communications with, a transmission and reception point (TRP) **150**. The network node **140** (via its TRP **150**) and the terminal device **200** is configured to communicate with each other in beams, one of which is illustrated at reference numeral **160**. In this respect, beams that could be used both as TX beams and RX beams will hereinafter simply be referred to as beams.

(16) Examples of network nodes **140** are radio access network nodes, radio base stations, base transceiver stations, Node Bs, evolved Node Bs, g NBs, access points, access nodes, and backhaul nodes. Examples of terminal devices **200** are wireless devices, mobile stations, mobile phones, handsets, wireless local loop phones, user equipment (UE), smartphones, laptop computers, tablet computers, network equipped sensors, network equipped vehicles, and so-called Internet of Things devices.

(17) There could be different types of antenna arrangements that the terminal device **200** is provided with in order for the terminal device **200** to efficiently communicate with the TRP **150**. In this respect, an antenna panel might be defined as a rectangular antenna array of dual-polarized antenna elements with typically one transmit/receive unit (TXRU) per polarization. An analog distribution network with phase shifters can be used to steer a directional beam as generated at each such antenna panel. Alternatively, the terminal device **200** is configured for digital wideband (time domain beamformed) beamforming that mimics the operation and function of the analog distribution network. Multiple antenna panels might be stacked next to each other and digital beamforming can be performed across the antenna panels. For the terminal device **200**, depending on its physical orientation, signals might arrive and emanate from all different directions. Hence, it might be beneficial to have an antenna implementation at the terminal device **200** which is enabled to generate omni-directional-like coverage for the terminal device **200** in addition to high gain narrow directional beams. One way to increase the omni-directional coverage at the terminal device **200** is to provide the terminal device **200** with multiple antenna panels, where at least two of the antenna panels have different pointing directions.

(18) FIG. 2 schematically illustrates an example antenna architecture of the terminal device **200**. According to the illustrated antenna architecture, the terminal device **200** is equipped with at least one antenna array **240a**, **240b**. Each antenna array **240a**, **240b** has dual-polarized antenna elements. In the illustrated example, each antenna array **240a**, **240b** has eight dual-polarized antenna elements but as the skilled person understands, each antenna array **240a**, **240b** might have less than eight dual-polarized antenna elements or more than eight dual-polarized antenna elements. The antenna arrays **240a**, **240b** are connectable to a baseband chain **250** in the terminal device **200** (via a switch **260**). In some examples the terminal device **200** is equipped with more than one antenna array **240a**, **240b**. Then the two or more antenna arrays **240a**, **240b** could selectively be connected to one and the same baseband chain **250**, one at a time. This enables the terminal device **200** to comprise just one single baseband chain **250** despite comprising two or more antenna arrays **240a**, **240b**. In other examples, the terminal device **200** comprises two or more baseband chains **250**, where each baseband chain **250** is connectable to one or more antenna arrays **240a**, **240b**. This enables each antenna array **240a**, **240b** to have its own baseband chain **250**. The antenna architecture might be part of a communications interface **220** of the terminal device **200**.

(19) As noted above there is still a need for improved beam management procedures. Reference is therefore made to FIG. 3 that schematically illustrates a beam management procedure consisting of three sub-procedures, referred to as P-1, P-2, and P-3 sub-procedures. These three sub-procedures will now be disclosed in more detail.

(20) One main purpose of the P-1 sub-procedure is for the network node **140** to find a coarse direction towards the terminal device **200** by transmitting reference signals in wide, but narrower than sector, beams that are swept over the whole angular sector. The TRP **150** is expected to, for the P-1 sub-procedure, utilize beams, according to a spatial beam pattern **160a**, with rather large beam widths. During the P-1 sub-procedure, the reference signals are typically transmitted periodically and are shared between all terminal devices **200** served by the network node **140** in the radio access network **110**. The terminal device **200** uses a wide, or even omni-directional beam for receiving the reference signals during the P-1 sub-procedure, according to a spatial beam pattern **170a**. The reference signals might be periodically transmitted channel state information reference signals (CSI-RS) or synchronization signal blocks (SSB). The terminal device might then to the network node **140** report the $N \geq 1$ best beams and their corresponding quality values, such as reference signal received power (RSRP) values. The beam reporting from the terminal device **200** to the network node **140** might be performed rather seldom (in order to save overhead) and can be either periodic, semi-persistent or aperiodic.

(21) One main purpose of the P-2 sub-procedure is to refine the beam selection at the TRP **150** by the network node **140** transmitting reference signals whilst performing a new beam sweep with more narrow directional beams, according to a spatial beam pattern **160b**, than those beams used during the P-1 sub-procedure, where the new beam sweep is performed around the coarse direction, or beam, reported during the P-1 sub-procedure. During the P-2 sub-procedure, the terminal device **200** typically uses the same beam as during the P-1 sub-procedure, according to a spatial beam pattern **170b**. The terminal device **200** might then to the network node **140** report the $N \geq 1$ best beams and their corresponding quality values, such as reference signal received power (RSRP) values. One P-2 sub-procedure might be performed per each terminal device **200** or per each group of terminal devices **200**. The reference signals might be aperiodically or semi-persistently transmitted CSI-RS. The P-2 sub-procedure might be performed more frequently than the P-1 sub-procedure in order to track movements of the terminal device **200** and/or changes in the radio propagation environment.

(22) One main purpose of the P-3 sub-procedure is for terminal devices **200** utilizing analog beamforming, or digital wideband (time domain beamformed) beamforming, to find best beam. During the P-3 sub-procedure, the reference signals are transmitted, according to a spatial beam pattern **160c**, in the best reported beam of the P-2 sub-procedure whilst the terminal device **200** performs a beam sweep, according to a spatial beam pattern **170c**. The P-3 sub-procedure might be performed at least as frequently as the P-2 sub-procedure in order to enable the terminal device **200** to compensate for blocking, and/or rotation.

(23) Due to the physical radio environment, which is reported as the best beam might be different for different polarizations. For example, for some non-line of sight (NLOS) radio propagation environments, what is reported as the strongest beam in one polarization might correspond to the weakest beam in the orthogonal polarization. One way to mitigate this is to switch the polarization of the beams at the TRP **150** between transmission of consecutive SSB. However, such switching might create problems for automatic gain control (AGC) as performed by the terminal device **200**. One reason for this is due to that the received power of the two SSBs transmitted for the two orthogonal polarizations might differ too much, for example more than 10 dB.

(24) One alternative way for the terminal device **200** to find its best beam, instead of using a P-3 sub-procedure is for the terminal device **200** to evaluate different beams during the periodic SSB transmission after initial network access. Since each SSB consists of four orthogonal frequency-division multiplexing (OFDM) symbols, a maximum of four beams can be evaluated during each SSB burst transmission. One benefit with this is that no extra overhead of CSI-RS transmission is needed. One drawback, however, with determining the beam to use at the terminal device **200** based on SSB transmission is that an SSB only has one TRP port, and hence only is transmitted over one polarization (per each unique direction), which implies that the terminal device **200** might

only be able to evaluate suitable beams for one polarization. But as noted above, in case the RSRP differs significantly for different polarizations there is a risk that a non-optimal beam is selected at the terminal device **200**.

(25) The embodiments disclosed herein therefore relate to mechanisms for polarized reception of reference signals. In order to obtain such mechanisms there is provided a terminal device **200**, a method performed by the terminal device **200**, a computer program product comprising code, for example in the form of a computer program, that when run on a terminal device **200**, causes the terminal device **200** to perform the method.

(26) FIG. 4 is a flowchart illustrating embodiments of methods for polarized reception of reference signals. The methods are performed by the terminal device **200**. The methods are advantageously provided as computer programs **820**.

(27) During the beam management procedure, the terminal device **200** receives two reference signals within the same slot using two different polarizations. In particular, the terminal device **200** is configured to perform step **S102**:

(28) **S102**: The terminal device **200** receives, during a beam management procedure with a TRP **150**, two reference signals transmitted in one OFDM symbol each from the same TRP port within a slot. The two reference signals are received using a filter with a first polarization for a first of the two reference signals and with a second polarization for a second of the two reference signals. The second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.

(29) The beam management procedures thereby takes into account the antenna architecture at the terminal device **200**.

(30) Embodiments relating to further details of polarized reception of reference signals as performed by the terminal device **200** will now be disclosed.

(31) If dual-polarized beamforming is used, the polarization will be different in different directions so there will not be one single polarization in all directions. This does not matter as long as the first polarization and the second polarization are orthogonal to each other.

(32) In some aspects, the terminal device **200** might be configured to determine if, and if so how much, it has been rotated. The terminal device **200** might further be configured to, in case it is determined that the terminal device **200** has been rotated, evaluates the polarization state again. Hence, a rotation criterion can be applied by the terminal device **200** for evaluating its polarization state. In particular, according to an embodiment, each of the first polarization and the second polarization is defined by their own polarization state, and which polarization state that defines each of the first polarization and the second polarization depends on rotational orientation of the terminal device **200**. Further, as long as the terminal device **200** has not rotated, there might not be any need for evaluation of different polarization states since the polarization state might not change as long as the terminal device **200** keeps its orientation. In particular, according to an embodiment, which polarization state that defines each of the first polarization and the second polarization remains unchanged as long as the rotational orientation of the terminal device **200** remains unchanged.

(33) Embodiments according to which the polarization is changed at the terminal device **200** when receiving the reference signals in order to reduce the risk of polarization mismatch will now be disclosed. In some aspects, these embodiments can be readily combined with the above described P-1 sub-procedure.

(34) In some aspects, the terminal device **200** calculates one quality value, such as RSRP, based on the reference signals as received in both OFDM symbols. That is, according to an embodiment, the terminal device **200** is configured to perform (optional) step **S104**:

(35) **S104**: The terminal device **200** determines one common RSRP value from measurements as performed by the terminal device **200** on both the two reference signals.

(36) In this respect, one individual RSRP value could first be determined for each of the two reference signals. The one common RSRP value could then be determined as the highest of these

two individual RSRP values. Alternatively, the one common RSRP value could then be determined as an average of the two individual RSRP values.

(37) As disclosed above, there could be different types of reference signals that the network node **140** transmits. In some examples, the two reference signals are received in an SSB. Further, in this, the SSB might in total comprise four reference signals as transmitted in one OFDM symbol each from the same TRP port within the slot. The one common RSRP value might then be determined from measurements as performed by the terminal device **200** on all the four reference signals. The RSRP of an SSB might, for example, be calculated based on a primary synchronization signal (PSS), a secondary synchronization signal (SSS) signal, demodulation reference signals (DMRS) that is frequency multiplexed with physical broadcast channel (PBCH) signalling, or even the control information symbols of the PBCH could be used. This means that 3 or 4 OFDM symbols of an SSB can be used by the terminal device **200** to determine the RSRP of that SSB.

(38) When the herein disclosed embodiments are combined with the above described P-1 sub-procedure, the step of receiving reference signals and the step of determining an RSRP value might be repeated for each beam in the beam sweep. Hence, according to an embodiment, during the beam management procedure with the TRP **150**, two further reference signals transmitted in one OFDM symbol each from the same TRP port are received. The two further reference signals are received using the filter with the first polarization for a first of the two further reference signals and with the second polarization for a second of the two further reference signals. One common RSRP value from measurements as performed by the terminal device **200** on both the two further reference signals is determined.

(39) These two further reference signals might be transmitted in a different beam at the TRP **150** compared to the above referred to two reference signals. According to an embodiment, the two further reference signals are received in a further SSB.

(40) The terminal device **200** might then report back to the network node **140**, via the TRP **150**, the SSB received with highest RSRP value (or highest other type of quality value). That is, according to an embodiment, the terminal device **200** is configured to perform (optional) step **S106**:

(41) **S106**: The terminal device **200** reports, to the TRP **150**, which of the SSBs was received with highest RSRP.

(42) In some examples, all reference signals are received using the same beam at the terminal device. That is, according to an embodiment, the two reference signals are received using one and the same beam at the terminal device **200**.

(43) One non-limiting example of how these embodiments could be readily combined with the above described P-1 sub-procedure will now be disclosed.

(44) Assume that the P-1 sub-procedure is based on transmission of reference signals in the form of SSBs. In this case the terminal device **200** will perform RSRP measurements on all different SSBs in an SSB burst and report the SSB index and corresponding RSRP of the N ($1 \leq N < 5$) SSBs with highest RSRP. Since polarization mismatching might cause a severe drop in the received power, the terminal device **200** switches polarization of the beam used to receive the SSB during one SSB, so that the RSRP is calculated in at least one OFDM symbol for each of two orthogonal polarization. In this way the SSB beam selection reported to the TRP will be more reliable. For example, assume that there is a polarization mismatch between the TRP **150** and the terminal device **200** such that the received power becomes very poor, then the RSRP measurements might be very unreliable. Another example is that the terminal device **200** might experience line of sight (LOS) conditions towards the TRP **150**, but due to polarization mismatch the RSRP for the LOS beam might yield poor RSRP, and an NLOS beam (e.g., a beam that is reflected on another object) that reach the terminal device **200** with changed polarization, might yield better RSRP. This might cause the terminal device **200** to select the NLOS beam, even though the LOS beam would have yield much higher RSRP if the TRP **150** and the terminal device **200** were not mismatched with respect to polarization.

(45) Embodiments according to which the terminal device **200** evaluates reference signals received in different polarizations in different ways in order select not only the best beam but also polarization state for the beam will now be disclosed. In some aspects, these embodiments can be readily combined with the above described P-3 sub-procedure.

(46) For a P-3 sub-procedure, when the network node **140** transmits reference signals in terms of CSI-RS, there can be two reference signals in each OFDM symbol by using two port CSI-RS resources.

(47) There could be different ways for the terminal device **200** to evaluate the beams for different polarizations in different ways.

(48) In some aspects, different spatial beam patterns are used when receiving the reference signals in the different polarizations. Particularly, according to an embodiment, the first of the two reference signals and the second of the two reference signals are received using mutually different spatial beam patterns. In this respect, the first of the two reference signals might be received using a first spatial beam pattern, the second of the two reference signals might be received using a second spatial beam pattern, where the second spatial beam pattern is different from to the first spatial beam pattern. As above, the first polarization is used when the first of the two reference signals is received and the second polarization is used when the second of the two reference signals is received. Thus the first spatial beam pattern is used for the first polarization and the second spatial beam pattern is used for the second polarization.

(49) Parallel reference is here made to FIG. 5 which at (a), (b) and (c) illustrates three examples of spatial beam patterns **180a**, **180b**, **180c** as generated by the terminal device **200** for the different polarizations P1 and P2. The spatial beam patterns for the different polarizations differ from each other in FIG. 5(a) and FIG. 5(b) but are the same in FIG. 5(c). Taking FIG. 5(a) as an example, narrow beams are generated where the polarization changes from beam to beam such that the polarization is orthogonal between adjacent beams. As long as there is some angular spread around the terminal device **200**, even if there is a polarization mismatch between the TRP **150** and one of the polarizations of the beams in FIG. 5(a), it is likely that the RSRP will be sufficiently high for some of the beams of the other polarization well (depending e.g. on how dense the beams are located in the angular dimension). If the beams are generated from a two-times over-sampled discrete Fourier transform (DFT) grid of beams, then the drop in RSRP is rather small. It is also expected that the UE in UE capability signaling can report how many UE beams that it would like to evaluate during a beam management procedure, and in this case the UE can signal a number that gives a good enough distance between the beams. The example of FIG. 5(b) might correspond to a scenario where the terminal device **200** has earlier determined a preferred polarization state, and therefore most of the narrow beams are generated with this (first) polarization. However, to evaluate if the previously best polarization still is preferred, the terminal device **200** generates one wider beam in the orthogonal (second) polarization. In case for example the RSRP of the wide beam almost is the same as the strongest narrow beam, it is likely that the polarization of the wide beam is preferred, since that beam has lower gain. Taking FIG. 5(c) as an example, the terminal device **200** generates slightly wider beams compared to FIGS. 5(a) and 4(b), and receives the reference signals in each beam for both polarizations. In this way a preferred direction and polarization can be determined by the terminal device **200**.

(50) In some aspects, the spatial beam patterns differ from each other by having different pointing directions. That is, according to an embodiment, the first spatial beam pattern has a first pointing direction, the second spatial beam pattern has a second pointing direction, and the second pointing direction is different from to the first pointing direction. This is the case for the example in FIG. 5(a) and partly in FIG. 5(b).

(51) In some aspects, the spatial beam patterns differ from each other by having different beam widths. That is, according to an embodiment, the first spatial beam pattern has a first beam width, the second spatial beam pattern has a second beam width, and the second beam width is different

from to the first beam width. This is the case for the example in FIG. 5(b).

(52) In some aspects, the spatial beam patterns differ from each other by having different number of beams. That is, according to an embodiment, the first spatial beam pattern is defined by a first set of beams, the second spatial beam pattern is defined by a second set of beams, and there are unequally many beams in the first set of beams and in the second set of beams. This is the case for the example in FIG. 5(b).

(53) One non-limiting example of how these embodiments could be readily combined with the above described P-3 sub-procedure will now be disclosed.

(54) During a beam sweep (either based on reference signals such as CSI-RS or SSB as transmitted in one and the same beam at the TRP **150**) performed as part of the P-3 procedure the terminal device **200** sweeps through beams in two orthogonal polarizations. Some different variants of how such a beam sweep could be performed is illustrated at (a), (b) and (c) in FIG. 5 as previously referred to.

(55) FIG. 6 schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional units, the components of a terminal device **200** according to an embodiment. Processing circuitry **210** is provided using any combination of one or more of a suitable central processing unit (CPU), multiprocessor, microcontroller, digital signal processor (DSP), etc., capable of executing software instructions stored in a computer program product **810** (as in FIG. 8), e.g. in the form of a storage medium **230**. The processing circuitry **210** may further be provided as at least one application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or field programmable gate array (FPGA).

(56) Particularly, the processing circuitry **210** is configured to cause the terminal device **200** to perform a set of operations, or steps, as disclosed above. For example, the storage medium **230** may store the set of operations, and the processing circuitry **210** may be configured to retrieve the set of operations from the storage medium **230** to cause the terminal device **200** to perform the set of operations. The set of operations may be provided as a set of executable instructions.

(57) Thus the processing circuitry **210** is thereby arranged to execute methods as herein disclosed. The storage medium **230** may also comprise persistent storage, which, for example, can be any single one or combination of magnetic memory, optical memory, solid state memory or even remotely mounted memory. The terminal device **200** may further comprise a communications interface **220** at least configured for communications with the network node **140** via the TRP **150**. As such the communications interface **220** may comprise one or more transmitters and receivers, comprising analogue and digital components. In this respect, the communications interface **220** might comprise, or be operatively connected to, an antenna architecture as described above with reference to FIG. 2.

(58) The processing circuitry **210** controls the general operation of the terminal device **200** e.g. by sending data and control signals to the communications interface **220** and the storage medium **230**, by receiving data and reports from the communications interface **220**, and by retrieving data and instructions from the storage medium **230**. Other components, as well as the related functionality, of the terminal device **200** are omitted in order not to obscure the concepts presented herein.

(59) FIG. 7 schematically illustrates, in terms of a number of functional modules, the components of a terminal device **200** according to an embodiment. The terminal device **200** of FIG. 7 comprises a receive module **210a** configured to perform step **S102**. The terminal device **200** of FIG. 7 may further comprise a number of optional functional modules, such as any of a determine module **210b** configured to perform step **S104**, and a report module **210c** configured to perform step **S106**. In general terms, each functional module **210a-210c** may in one embodiment be implemented only in hardware and in another embodiment with the help of software, i.e., the latter embodiment having computer program instructions stored on the storage medium **230** which when run on the processing circuitry makes the terminal device **200** perform the corresponding steps mentioned above in conjunction with FIG. 6. It should also be mentioned that even though the modules correspond to parts of a computer program, they do not need to be separate modules therein, but the

way in which they are implemented in software is dependent on the programming language used. Preferably, one or more or all functional modules **210a-210c** may be implemented by the processing circuitry **210**, possibly in cooperation with the communications interface **220** and/or the storage medium **230**. The processing circuitry **210** may thus be configured to from the storage medium **230** fetch instructions as provided by a functional module **210a-210c** and to execute these instructions, thereby performing any steps as disclosed herein.

(60) FIG. **8** shows one example of a computer program product **810** comprising computer readable storage medium **830**. On this computer readable storage medium **830**, a computer program **820** can be stored, which computer program **820** can cause the processing circuitry **210** and thereto operatively coupled entities and devices, such as the communications interface **220** and the storage medium **230**, to execute methods according to embodiments described herein. The computer program **820** and/or computer program product **810** may thus provide means for performing any steps as herein disclosed.

(61) In the example of FIG. **8**, the computer program product **810** is illustrated as an optical disc, such as a CD (compact disc) or a DVD (digital versatile disc) or a Blu-Ray disc. The computer program product **810** could also be embodied as a memory, such as a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM), or an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM) and more particularly as a non-volatile storage medium of a device in an external memory such as a USB (Universal Serial Bus) memory or a Flash memory, such as a compact Flash memory. Thus, while the computer program **820** is here schematically shown as a track on the depicted optical disk, the computer program **820** can be stored in any way which is suitable for the computer program product **810**.

(62) FIG. **9** is a schematic diagram illustrating a telecommunication network connected via an intermediate network **420** to a host computer **430** in accordance with some embodiments. In accordance with an embodiment, a communication system includes telecommunication network **410**, such as a 3GPP-type cellular network, which comprises access network **411**, such as radio access network **110** in FIG. **1**, and core network **414**, such as core network **120** in FIG. **1**. Access network **411** comprises a plurality of radio access network nodes **412a**, **412b**, **412c**, such as NBs, eNBs, gNBs (each corresponding to the network node **140** of FIG. **1**) or other types of wireless access points, each defining a corresponding coverage area, or cell, **413a**, **413b**, **413c**. Each radio access network nodes **412a**, **412b**, **412c** is connectable to core network **414** over a wired or wireless connection **415**. A first UE **491** located in coverage area **413c** is configured to wirelessly connect to, or be paged by, the corresponding network node **412c**. A second UE **492** in coverage area **413a** is wirelessly connectable to the corresponding network node **412a**. While a plurality of UE **491**, **492** are illustrated in this example, the disclosed embodiments are equally applicable to a situation where a sole UE is in the coverage area or where a sole terminal device is connecting to the corresponding network node **412**. The UEs **491**, **492** correspond to the terminal device **200** of FIG. **1**.

(63) Telecommunication network **410** is itself connected to host computer **430**, which may be embodied in the hardware and/or software of a standalone server, a cloud-implemented server, a distributed server or as processing resources in a server farm. Host computer **430** may be under the ownership or control of a service provider, or may be operated by the service provider or on behalf of the service provider. Connections **421** and **422** between telecommunication network **410** and host computer **430** may extend directly from core network **414** to host computer **430** or may go via an optional intermediate network **420**. Intermediate network **420** may be one of, or a combination of more than one of, a public, private or hosted network; intermediate network **420**, if any, may be a backbone network or the Internet; in particular, intermediate network **420** may comprise two or more sub-networks (not shown).

(64) The communication system of FIG. **9** as a whole enables connectivity between the connected UEs **491**, **492** and host computer **430**. The connectivity may be described as an over-the-top (OTT)

connection **450**. Host computer **430** and the connected UEs **491**, **492** are configured to communicate data and/or signaling via OTT connection **450**, using access network **411**, core network **414**, any intermediate network **420** and possible further infrastructure (not shown) as intermediaries. OTT connection **450** may be transparent in the sense that the participating communication devices through which OTT connection **450** passes are unaware of routing of uplink and downlink communications. For example, network node **412** may not or need not be informed about the past routing of an incoming downlink communication with data originating from host computer **430** to be forwarded (e.g., handed over) to a connected UE **491**. Similarly, network node **412** need not be aware of the future routing of an outgoing uplink communication originating from the UE **491** towards the host computer **430**.

(65) FIG. **10** is a schematic diagram illustrating host computer communicating via a radio access network node with a UE over a partially wireless connection in accordance with some embodiments. Example implementations, in accordance with an embodiment, of the UE, radio access network node and host computer discussed in the preceding paragraphs will now be described with reference to FIG. **10**. In communication system **500**, host computer **510** comprises hardware **515** including communication interface **516** configured to set up and maintain a wired or wireless connection with an interface of a different communication device of communication system **500**. Host computer **510** further comprises processing circuitry **518**, which may have storage and/or processing capabilities. In particular, processing circuitry **518** may comprise one or more programmable processors, application-specific integrated circuits, field programmable gate arrays or combinations of these (not shown) adapted to execute instructions. Host computer **510** further comprises software **511**, which is stored in or accessible by host computer **510** and executable by processing circuitry **518**. Software **511** includes host application **512**. Host application **512** may be operable to provide a service to a remote user, such as UE **530** connecting via OTT connection **550** terminating at UE **530** and host computer **510**. The UE **530** corresponds to the terminal device **200** of FIG. **1**. In providing the service to the remote user, host application **512** may provide user data which is transmitted using OTT connection **550**.

(66) Communication system **500** further includes radio access network node **520** provided in a telecommunication system and comprising hardware **525** enabling it to communicate with host computer **510** and with UE **530**. The radio access network node **520** corresponds to the network node **140** of FIG. **1**. Hardware **525** may include communication interface **526** for setting up and maintaining a wired or wireless connection with an interface of a different communication device of communication system **500**, as well as radio interface **527** for setting up and maintaining at least wireless connection **570** with UE **530** located in a coverage area (not shown in FIG. **10**) served by radio access network node **520**. Communication interface **526** may be configured to facilitate connection **560** to host computer **510**. Connection **560** may be direct or it may pass through a core network (not shown in FIG. **10**) of the telecommunication system and/or through one or more intermediate networks outside the telecommunication system. In the embodiment shown, hardware **525** of radio access network node **520** further includes processing circuitry **528**, which may comprise one or more programmable processors, application-specific integrated circuits, field programmable gate arrays or combinations of these (not shown) adapted to execute instructions. Radio access network node **520** further has software **521** stored internally or accessible via an external connection.

(67) Communication system **500** further includes UE **530** already referred to. Its hardware **535** may include radio interface **537** configured to set up and maintain wireless connection **570** with a radio access network node serving a coverage area in which UE **530** is currently located. Hardware **535** of UE **530** further includes processing circuitry **538**, which may comprise one or more programmable processors, application-specific integrated circuits, field programmable gate arrays or combinations of these (not shown) adapted to execute instructions. UE **530** further comprises software **531**, which is stored in or accessible by UE **530** and executable by processing circuitry

538. Software 531 includes client application 532. Client application 532 may be operable to provide a service to a human or non-human user via UE 530, with the support of host computer 510. In host computer 510, an executing host application 512 may communicate with the executing client application 532 via OTT connection 550 terminating at UE 530 and host computer 510. In providing the service to the user, client application 532 may receive request data from host application 512 and provide user data in response to the request data. OTT connection 550 may transfer both the request data and the user data. Client application 532 may interact with the user to generate the user data that it provides.

(68) It is noted that host computer 510, radio access network node 520 and UE 530 illustrated in FIG. 10 may be similar or identical to host computer 430, one of network nodes 412a, 412b, 412c and one of UEs 491, 492 of FIG. 9, respectively. This is to say, the inner workings of these entities may be as shown in FIG. 10 and independently, the surrounding network topology may be that of FIG. 9.

(69) In FIG. 10, OTT connection 550 has been drawn abstractly to illustrate the communication between host computer 510 and UE 530 via network node 520, without explicit reference to any intermediary devices and the precise routing of messages via these devices. Network infrastructure may determine the routing, which it may be configured to hide from UE 530 or from the service provider operating host computer 510, or both. While OTT connection 550 is active, the network infrastructure may further take decisions by which it dynamically changes the routing (e.g., on the basis of load balancing consideration or reconfiguration of the network).

(70) Wireless connection 570 between UE 530 and radio access network node 520 is in accordance with the teachings of the embodiments described throughout this disclosure. One or more of the various embodiments improve the performance of OTT services provided to UE 530 using OTT connection 550, in which wireless connection 570 forms the last segment. More precisely, the teachings of these embodiments may reduce interference, due to improved classification ability of airborne UEs which can generate significant interference.

(71) A measurement procedure may be provided for the purpose of monitoring data rate, latency and other factors on which the one or more embodiments improve. There may further be an optional network functionality for reconfiguring OTT connection 550 between host computer 510 and UE 530, in response to variations in the measurement results. The measurement procedure and/or the network functionality for reconfiguring OTT connection 550 may be implemented in software 511 and hardware 515 of host computer 510 or in software 531 and hardware 535 of UE 530, or both. In embodiments, sensors (not shown) may be deployed in or in association with communication devices through which OTT connection 550 passes; the sensors may participate in the measurement procedure by supplying values of the monitored quantities exemplified above, or supplying values of other physical quantities from which software 511, 531 may compute or estimate the monitored quantities. The reconfiguring of OTT connection 550 may include message format, retransmission settings, preferred routing etc.; the reconfiguring need not affect network node 520, and it may be unknown or imperceptible to radio access network node 520. Such procedures and functionalities may be known and practiced in the art. In certain embodiments, measurements may involve proprietary UE signaling facilitating host computer's 510 measurements of throughput, propagation times, latency and the like. The measurements may be implemented in that software 511 and 531 causes messages to be transmitted, in particular empty or 'dummy' messages, using OTT connection 550 while it monitors propagation times, errors etc.

(72) The inventive concept has mainly been described above with reference to a few embodiments. However, as is readily appreciated by a person skilled in the art, other embodiments than the ones disclosed above are equally possible within the scope of the inventive concept, as defined by the appended patent claims.

Claims

1. A method for polarized reception of reference signals, the method being performed by a terminal device, the method comprising: performing a beam management procedure with a transmission and reception point (TRP) configured to transmit a first synchronization signal block (SSB) comprising a first reference signal and a second reference signal, wherein performing the beam management procedure comprises: receiving the first reference signal transmitted; and receiving the second reference signal, wherein the first SSB is transmitted over one polarization, the first reference signal is received using a filter with a first polarization, the second reference signal is received using a filter with a second polarization, and the second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the beam management procedure further comprises: determining one common reference signal received power (RSRP) value from measurements as performed by the terminal device on both the first and second reference signals.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the first and second reference signals are received using one and the same beam at the terminal device.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the SSB further comprises a third reference signal and a fourth reference signal.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the one common RSRP value is determined from measurements as performed by the terminal device on the first, second, third, and fourth reference signals.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the TRP is further configured to transmit a second SSB comprising a third reference signal and a fourth reference signal, and the beam management procedure further comprises: receiving the third reference signal using a filter with the first polarization, receiving the fourth reference signal using a filter with the second polarization, determining a first reference signal received power (RSRP) value from measurements as performed by the terminal device on both the first and second reference signals, and determining a second RSRP value from measurements as performed by the terminal device on both the third and further reference signals.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein the beam management procedure further comprises: reporting which of the first and second SSBs was received with highest RSRP.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the first reference signal is received using a first spatial beam pattern, and the second reference signal is received using a second spatial beam pattern that is different from the first spatial beam pattern.
9. The method of claim 8, wherein the first spatial beam pattern has a first pointing direction and the second spatial beam pattern has a second pointing direction different from the first pointing direction, and/or the first spatial beam pattern has a first width and the second spatial beam pattern has a second width different from the first width, and/or the first spatial beam pattern is defined by a first set of N beams and the second spatial beam pattern is defined by a first set of M beams, where N does not equal M.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein each of the first polarization and the second polarization is defined by their own polarization state, which polarization state that defines each of the first polarization and the second polarization depends on rotational orientation of the terminal device, and which polarization state that defines each of the first polarization and the second polarization remains unchanged as long as the rotational orientation of the terminal device remains unchanged.
11. A terminal device for polarized reception of reference signals, the terminal device comprising: a baseband chain; an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements, the antenna array being connected to the baseband chain; and processing circuitry, the processing circuitry being configured to cause the terminal device to perform a method comprising: performing a beam management procedure with a transmission and reception point (TRP) configured to transmit a first

synchronization signal block (SSB) comprising a first reference signal and a second reference signal, wherein performing the beam management procedure comprises: receiving the first reference signal transmitted; and receiving the second reference signal, wherein the first SSB is transmitted over one polarization, the first reference signal is received using a filter with a first polarization, the second reference signal is received using a filter with a second polarization, and the second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.

12. The terminal device of claim 11, wherein the beam management procedure further comprises: determining one common reference signal received power (RSRP) value from measurements as performed by the terminal device on both the first and second reference signals.

13. The terminal device of claim 11, wherein the first and second reference signals are received using one and the same beam at the terminal device.

14. The terminal device of claim 11, wherein the SSB further comprises a third reference signal and a fourth reference signal.

15. The terminal device of claim 14, wherein the one common RSRP value is determined from measurements as performed by the terminal device on the first, second, third, and fourth reference signals.

16. The terminal device of claim 11, wherein the TRP is further configured to transmit a second SSB comprising a third reference signal and a fourth reference signal, and the beam management procedure further comprises: receiving the third reference signal using a filter with the first polarization, receiving the fourth reference signal using a filter with the second polarization, determining a first reference signal received power (RSRP) value from measurements as performed by the terminal device on both the first and second reference signals, and determining a second RSRP value from measurements as performed by the terminal device on both the third and further reference signals.

17. The terminal device of claim 16, wherein the beam management procedure further comprises: reporting which of the first and second SSBs was received with highest RSRP.

18. The terminal device of claim 11, wherein the first reference signal is received using a first spatial beam pattern, and the second reference signal is received using a second spatial beam pattern that is different from the first spatial beam pattern.

19. The terminal device of claim 18, wherein the first spatial beam pattern has a first pointing direction and the second spatial beam pattern has a second pointing direction different from the first pointing direction, and/or the first spatial beam pattern has a first width and the second spatial beam pattern has a second width different from the first width, and/or the first spatial beam pattern is defined by a first set of N beams and the second spatial beam pattern is defined by a first set of M beams, where N does not equal M.

20. A non-transitory computer readable medium storing a computer program for polarized reception of reference signals, the computer program comprising computer code which, when run on processing circuitry of a terminal device equipped with an antenna array having dual-polarized antenna elements, the antenna array being connected to a baseband chain in the terminal device, causes the terminal device to perform a method comprising: performing a beam management procedure with a transmission and reception point (TRP) configured to transmit a first synchronization signal block (SSB) comprising a first reference signal and a second reference signal, wherein performing the beam management procedure comprises: receiving the first reference signal transmitted; and receiving the second reference signal, wherein the first SSB is transmitted over one polarization, the first reference signal is received using a filter with a first polarization, the second reference signal is received using a filter with a second polarization, and the second polarization is orthogonal to the first polarization.
